AHEAD OF THE CURVE

CM Himanta Biswa Sarma's strong work ethic and 24X7 governance model explain Assam's unprecedented leap in the path of development in the past year

By KAUSHIK DEKA

It was 15 minutes past midnight when the doorbell of Samir Sinha, principal secretary to Assam chief minister Himanta Biswa Sarma, rang. Jayant Narlikar, commissioner and secretary to the state's finance department, had come calling. The two had to iron out a couple of issues related to a few of the government schemes, but they also had CM Sarma on the phone line from his residence. Sarma and his two officers were engaged in intermittent conversations and by the time all the issues were resolved, it was nearly 2 am. In the administrative machinery of the Sarma-led Assam government, it was just a regular day, which usually begins at 8 in the morning. On some days, though, calls from the chief minister's office can start even at 7 am.

If Assam has demonstrated an unprecedented leap in the path of development in the past year, it can largely be attributed to this 24X7 governance model, where the CM keeps all stakeholders on their toes. Assam has not only emerged as the most improved big state overall, it has also improved rankings in the categories of infrastructure, agriculture, education, law & order, inclusive development, tourism and environment over the previous year. It has continuously posted double-digit growth in the past several years. It was among the few states that exhibited positive growth even during the pandemic. The average growth rate of Assam has remained higher than the national average for the past seven years. The GSDP of Assam at variable prices is expected to be



LEADING BY EXAMPLE Assam chief minister Himanta Biswa Sarma

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